5.3 Traumatic Brain Injury*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Family report a fall with a head injury **Objective** • GCS 11 • Unequal pupils • Vomiting; headache	**ACTUAL** Acute confusion related to traumatic brain injury as evidenced by reduced GCS, disorientation and pupillary change.	• GCS stable or improving, without signs of raised ICP.	• Assess GCS, pupils and vital signs as ordered, often hourly. • Raise the head of the bed to 30 degrees, head in midline. • Avoid neck flexion and keep tube ties loose. • Maintain oxygenation and normal CO_2. • Report a falling GCS, new pupil changes, or rising BP with bradycardia.	• Goal reached when GCS is stable or improving.
Subjective • "My head is pounding." **Objective** • Grimacing; pain 7/10	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to head trauma as evidenced by headache and grimacing.	• Headache at or below 3/10 within an hour of analgesia.	• Give the prescribed analgesic that will not mask neurological signs. • Cut down light and noise. • Keep the head of the bed at 30 degrees. • Reassess pain with each set of neuro observations.	• Met when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Head injury • Restless	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: altered level of consciousness and possible seizures.	• No injury.	• Use padded side rails per policy. • Keep the bed low. • Watch for seizures.	• Achieved if he remains uninjured.

* **References for this care plan:** [13], [35], [102], [124], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.